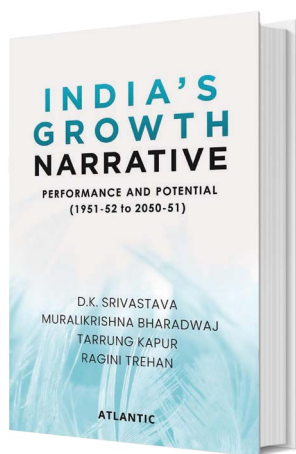

BOOK REVIEW

THE MODERN ECONOMY THROUGH AN ANCIENT LENS

Amid the volatile external situation, the book says the true Hindu growth rate is 7% plus and provides policy prescriptions for India's long-term growth story

BY **SURABHI**

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**INDIA'S GROWTH
NARRATIVE PERFORMANCE
AND POTENTIAL (1951-52
TO 2050-51)**

Author DK Srivastava,
Muralikrishna Bharadwaj,
Tarrung Kapur, Ragini Trehan

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THE INDIAN ECONOMY had a share of nearly 25% in global GDP in 1700 A.D., according to Maddison. If India is able to maintain a growth rate of 7% up to 2050-51, it will regain its lost position of economic pre-eminence of yesteryears," explain the authors of *India's Growth Narrative Performance and Potential (1951-52 to 2050-51)*.

The book is co-written by veteran economist DK Srivastava, who is Chief Policy Advisor at EY India, and was a member of the Twelfth Finance Commission and the Advisory Council to the Sixteenth Finance Commission, along with his colleagues at EY, including Muralikrishna Bharadwaj, Tarrung Kapur and Ragini Trehan. It provides a summary of India's economic growth rates over the past 75 years and the potential for the next 25 years while tracing the average GDP growth over seven time periods, coinciding with various phases in the economy (*see chart*).

The book contends that the lowest average growth of 3.5% during the late 1960s and early 1970s, often referred to as the "Hindu Rate of Growth," was the socialist phase, which was preceded by a colonial legacy phase.

Though a book focused on the economy, it is interspersed with *shlokas* and *mantras* from various sources, including *Shiv Purana*, *Raghuvansham*, *Manu Samhita* and *Mahabharat Shanti Parva*.

In fact, referring to ancient Indian literature that include these prayers, which have extensive guidance on economic matters for "*Artha*" or money, the authors argue that following their advice on